

Depot Replacement: Interim Service Report

To: Operations Committee

From: Network Planning

Date: 14 March

1. Purpose

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

2. Background

Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles.

2.1 Counting methodology

Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

2.2 Comparison with the previous phase

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint. Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles.

3. Findings

Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles. Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

3.1 Peak-hour circulation

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

3.2 Layover capacity

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison. The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

4. Recommendation

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison.

Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles. Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.